George jumped at it without a moment's hesitation and said he would be pleased to be on the ticket.

"Okay," I said, "I'm going to get in the car and go over to the convention right now and tell the people that you're my choice."

When I announced my decision to the throng of delegates crowded into the arena, they rose to their feet with a tremendous roar. The roof almost came off. As George and I stood there together, it was almost as if we were putting the party back together again. I then asked the delegates to join me in a silent prayer.

Now George and I faced a challenge together: beating Jimmy Carter and Walter Mondale.